04

2026

Gutsy

Designing a memorable unboxing journey for a pet-food start-up

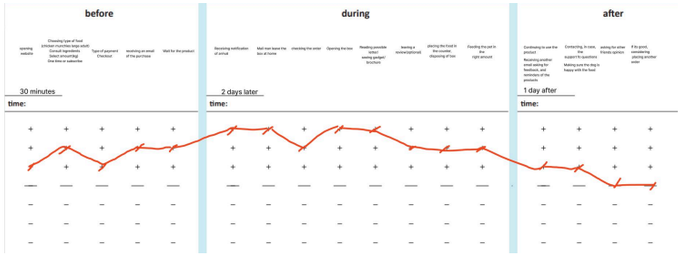


Methods & tools: customer journey mapping · desk research · survey analysis · competitor review · packaging-content ideation · iterative feedback

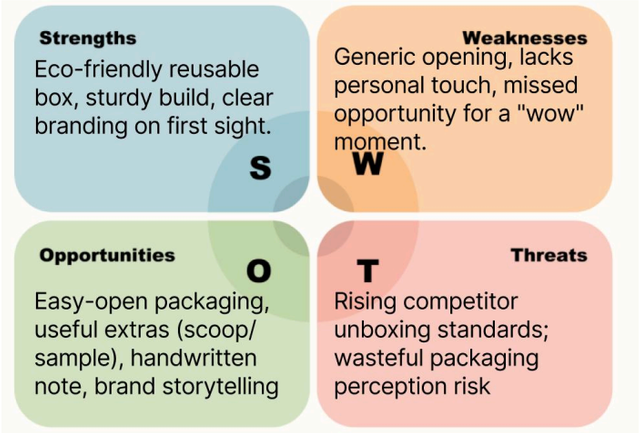
My role: Company and competitor analysis · Customer survey support · Unboxing research · Customer journey mapping · Packaging-content concepts · Iterative design development

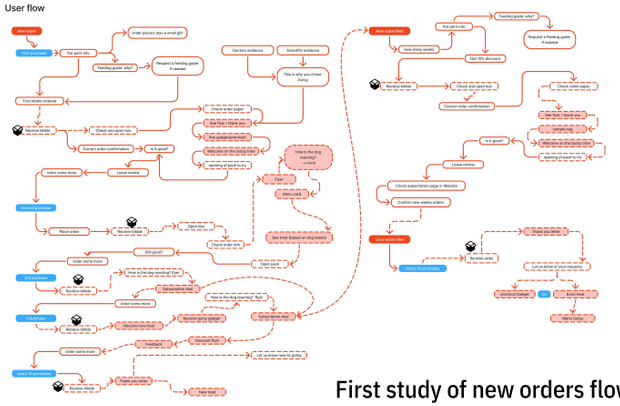
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RESEARCH AND DESIGN PROCESS

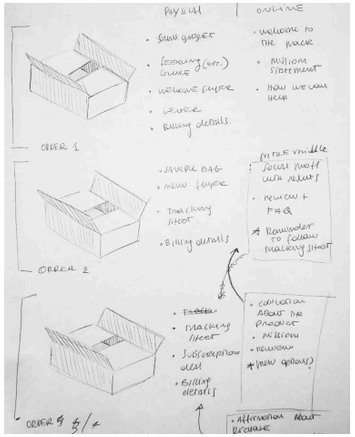


Current satisfaction flow when ordering





First study of new orders flow



Visualising the pack and what they contained



Expenses for new costumers

BRAND ANALYSIS, INTERVIEWS, SATISFACTION

During a two-month internship with a young pet-food start-up in Antwerp, I explored how packaging and post-purchase touchpoints could create a more memorable customer experience for pet owners.
How might Gutsy make the first unboxing **feel personal and reassuring, and keep that feeling even after repeated orders and subscriptions?**
After a brand analisys, several loyal costumers were asked about their experience in the un boxing satisfaction

FIRST STUDIES

The project examined how the experience could evolve across first purchases, repeat orders and subscriptions. I mapped what customers receive at each stage and developed content ideas designed to create clarity, surprise and continuity.

- **A clear first-order welcome experience.**
- **Feeding guidance based on pet information.**
- **Small welcome gifts and useful printed content.**
- **A long-term journey that rewards loyalty without repeating the same experience every time.**

GUTSY EXPENSES

I worked through weekly feedback sessions with my tutor, using research and iteration to refine the concept. The final output included content proposals for the package and a journey map explaining what customers receive, when they receive it and why each touchpoint matters.
It was essential for them to showcase how much the packages prints and gifts would have costed, so a template and costs was created

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FINAL DESIGNS



Thank you letter + brochures

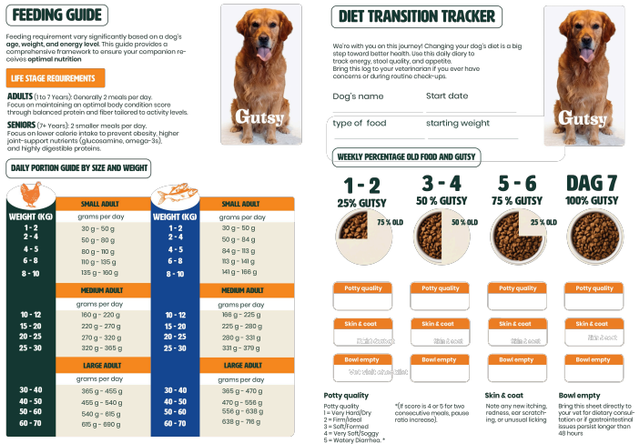
Gadget



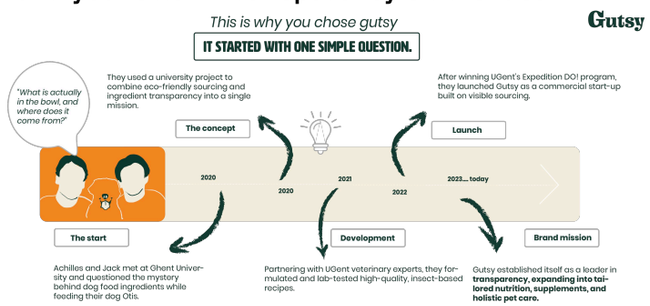




First order feeding instructions



Thank you letter - Transparency on the idea



Thank you letter - Transparency on the content

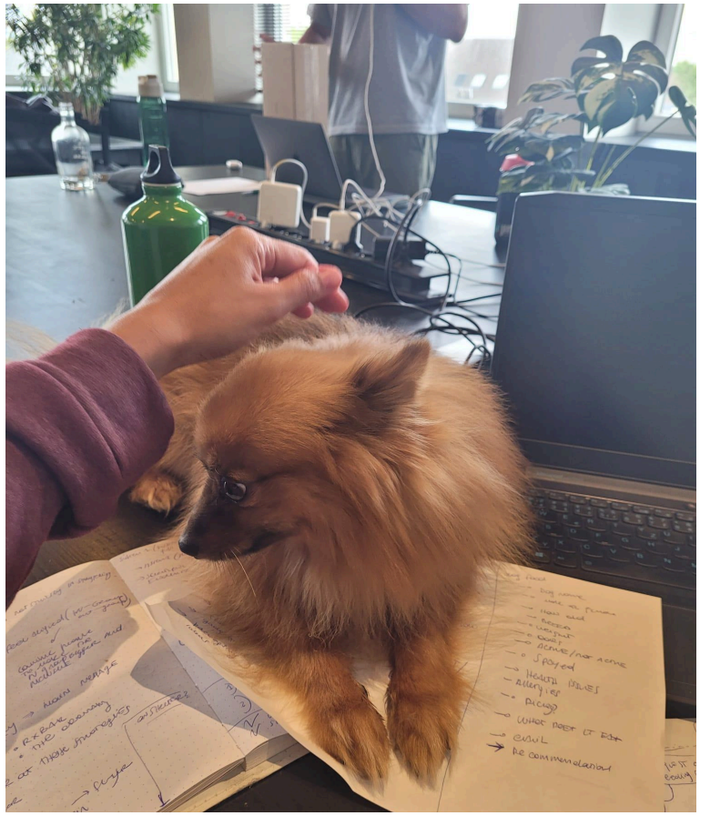


GRAPHIC PART

All the essential elements where highlighted:

- **Emit transparency to the client**
- **Show the boldness of the product**
- **Flexible with the new brand guidelines coming**
- **Honestly good and informed**

These elements are the design principles used in the illustrations and graphic work



A LIVELY OFFICE

As the internship came to an end, also my daily petting session with Olaf finished. The most interesting part was being in close contact with the founders and idea makers of the company, bold and passionate people that thought me a lot on what is a good costumer approach and the best marketing moves.

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